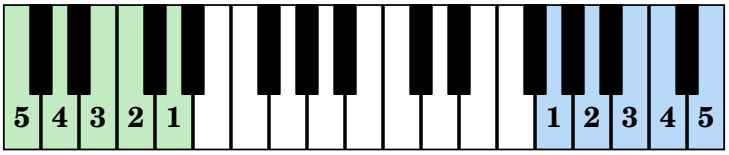
Unit 8

G Position

New: Moving the hands to G; fourths and fifths

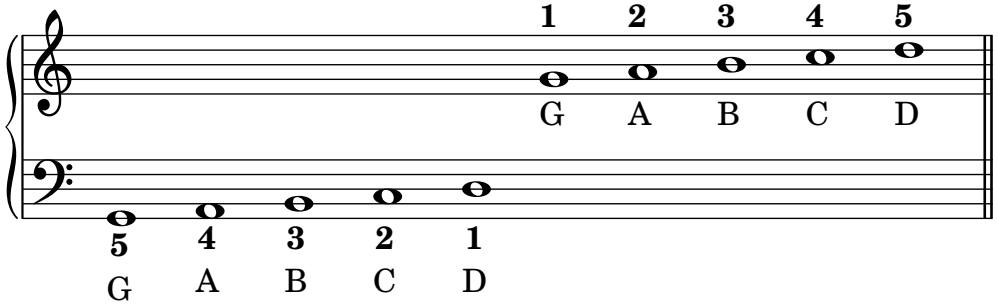
Both hands now move to a new home: G position. Right thumb on the G above middle C, fingers on G A B C D. Left little finger on the G that sits on the bottom line of the bass staff, fingers on G A B C D. You will also read bigger leaps: fourths and fifths.



Middle C

Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

New treble notes

G on the second line (where the clef curls), A in the second space, B on the middle line, C in the third space, D on the fourth line.

New bass notes

G on the bottom line, A in the bottom space, B on the second line, C in the second space, D on the middle line.

Naming intervals

Count the letter names, including both ends: C to D is a 2nd (a step), C to E a 3rd (a skip), C to F a 4th, C to G a 5th.

4ths and 5ths on the staff

A 4th goes from a line to a space (or a space to a line), jumping over two notes. A 5th goes from a line to the line after next, or a space to the space after next.

5ths in the hand

In a five-finger position a 5th is always thumb to little finger, so you can play it without naming the second note.

Reading tips

1. Your hands have moved. Before each exercise, use the finger number on the first note to check which key you start on.

2. Use the G landmarks: the treble clef curls around G, and the bass staff's bottom line is G.

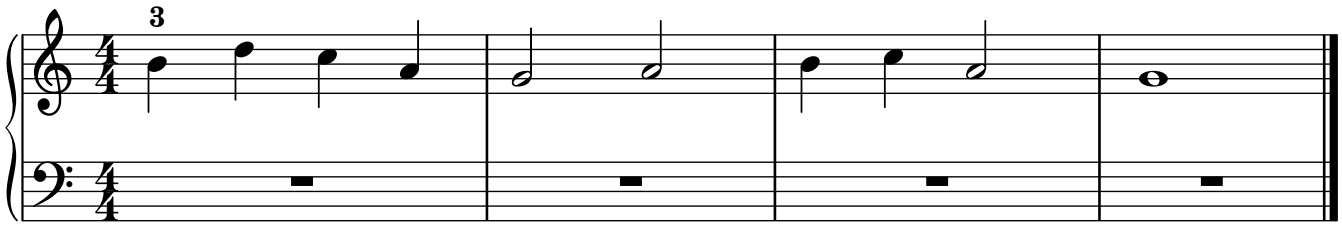
3. Read 4ths and 5ths as shapes: line-to-space jumps, and line-to-line or space-to-space jumps with one line or space in between.

4. Bigger leaps tempt you to look down. Trust the position: every note is still under a finger.

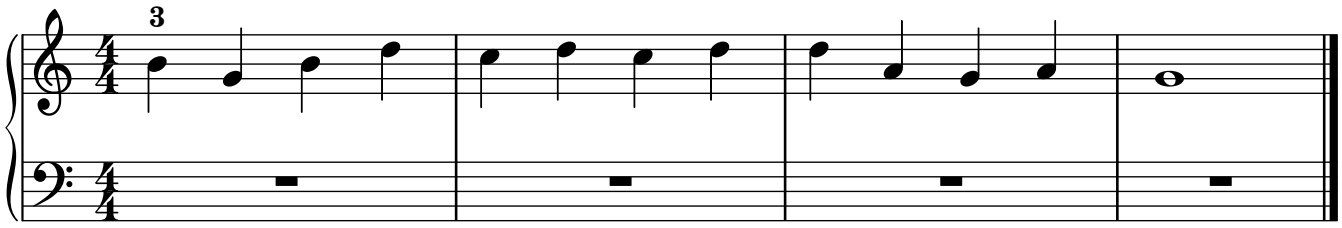
Part A: Right hand in G ♩= 60

Right hand in G position, with intervals up to a 5th. Metronome 60.

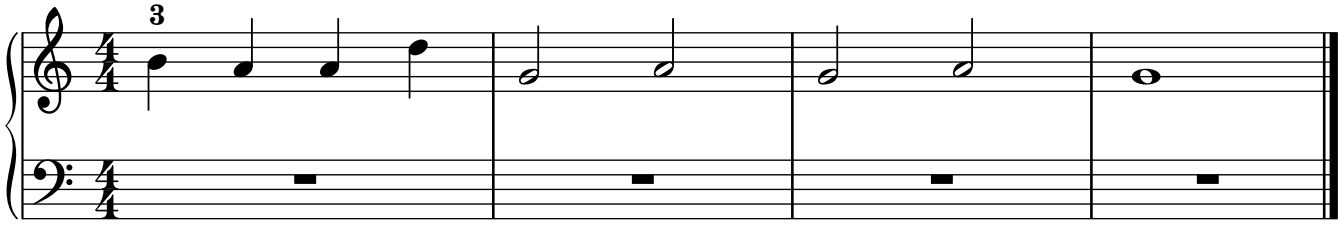
☐ **8.1**



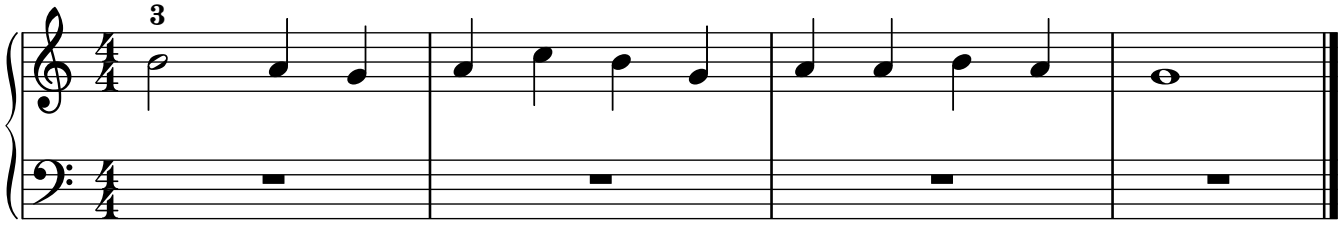
☐ **8.2**



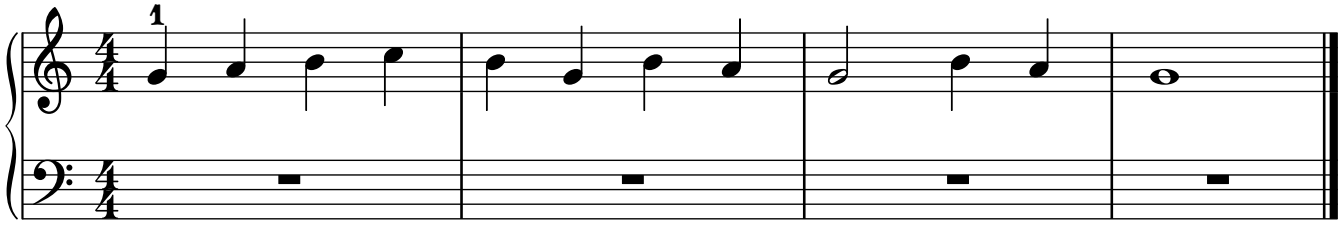
☐ **8.3**



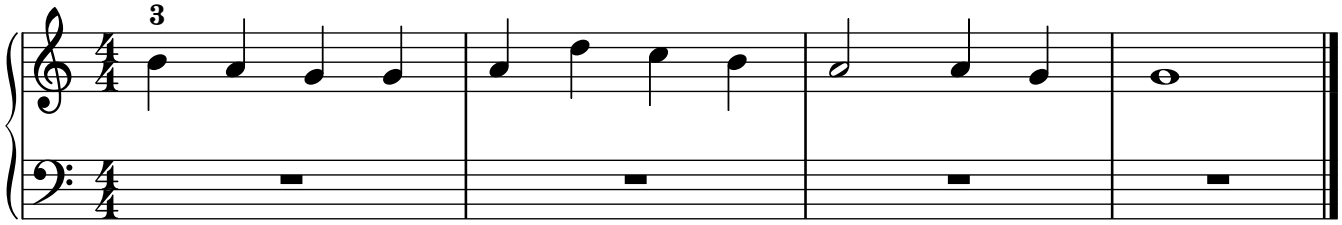
☐ **8.4**



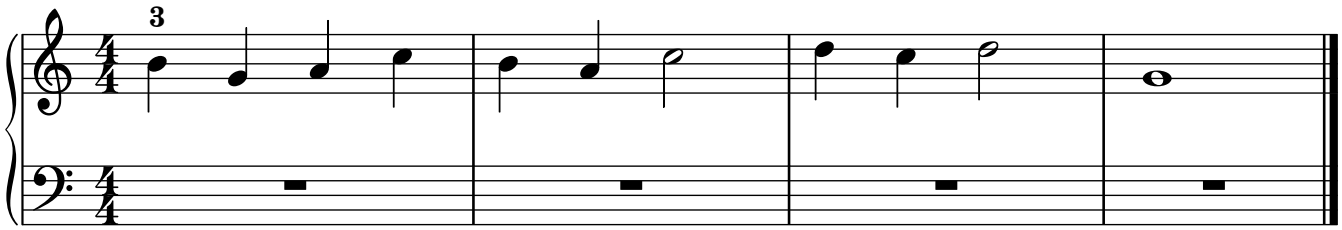
☐ **8.5**



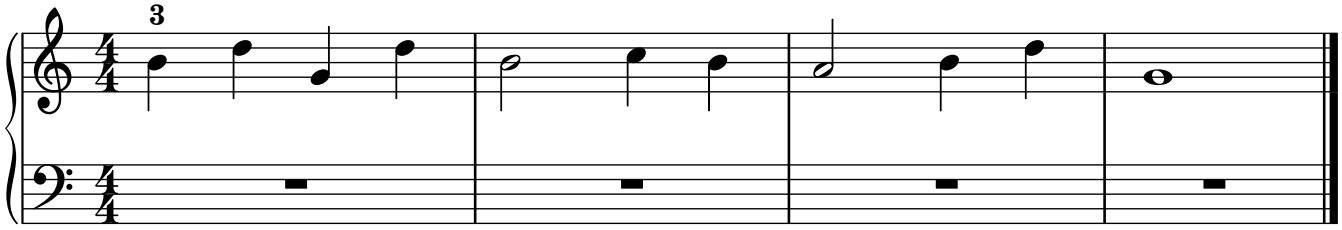
☐ **8.6**



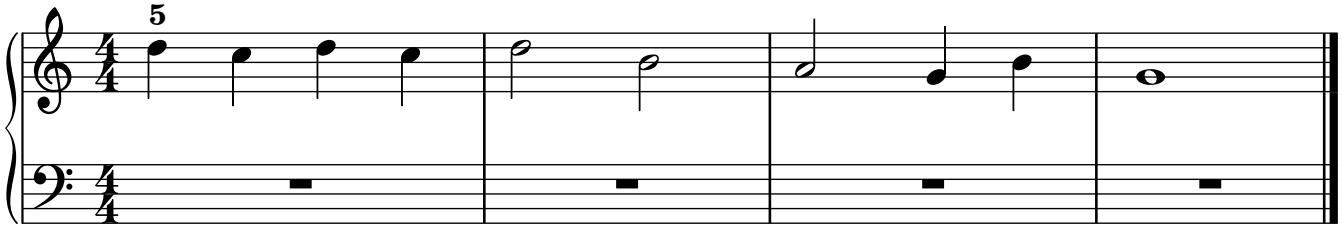
☐ **8.7**



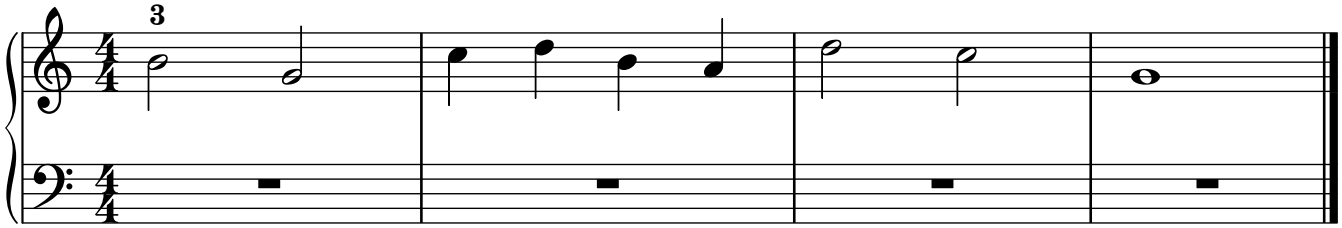
☐ **8.8**



☐ **8.9**



☐ **8.10**



Part B: Hands together in G ♩= 60

Hands together in G position: the left hand holds G (finger 5) or D (finger 1).

☐ **8.11**



☐ **8.12**



☐ **8.13**



8.14



8.15



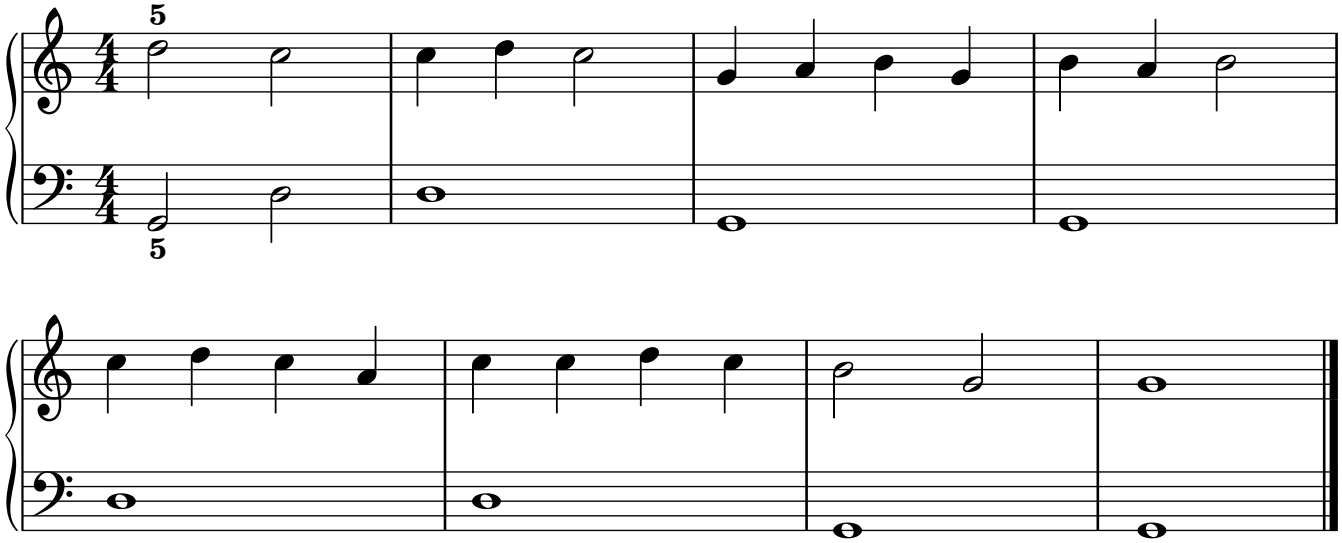
8.16



8.17



8.18



8.19



8.20



8.21



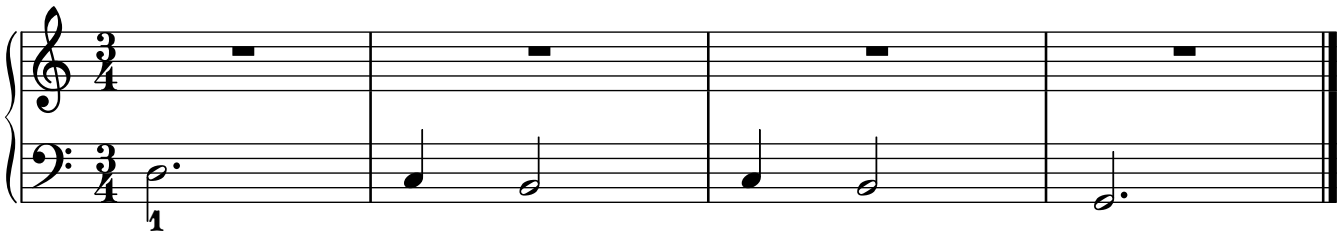
8.22



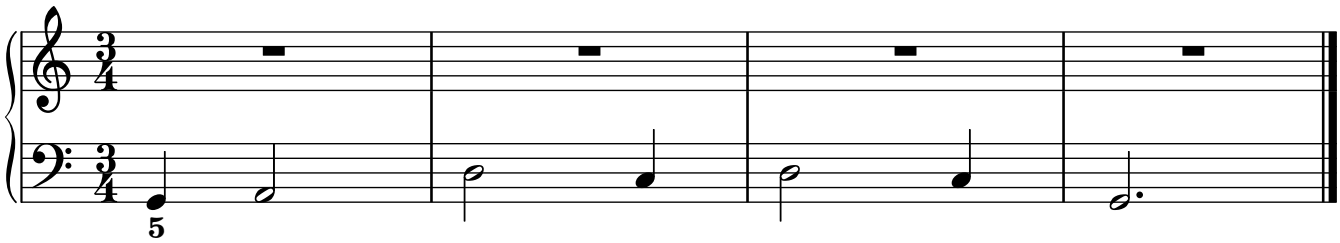
Part C: Left hand in G ♩ = 72

Left hand in G position, in 3/4.

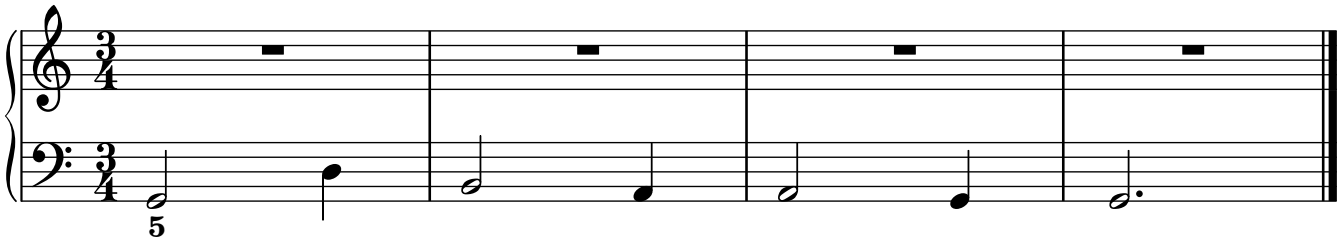
☐ **8.23**



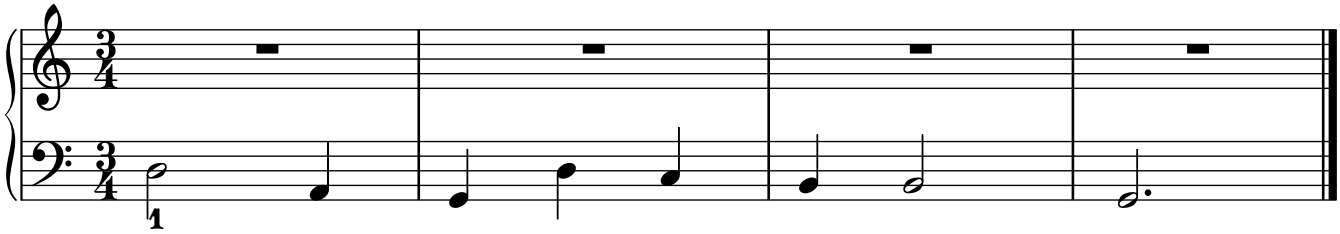
☐ **8.24**



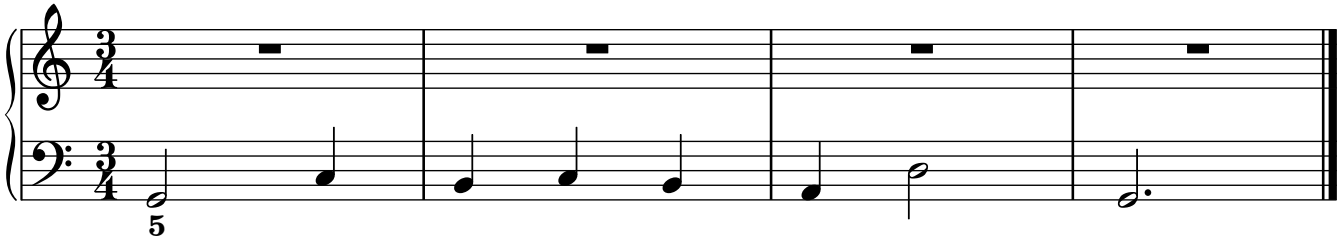
☐ **8.25**



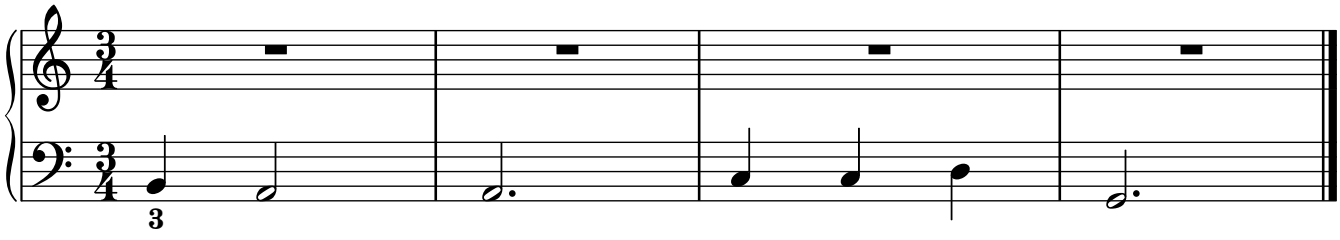
☐ **8.26**



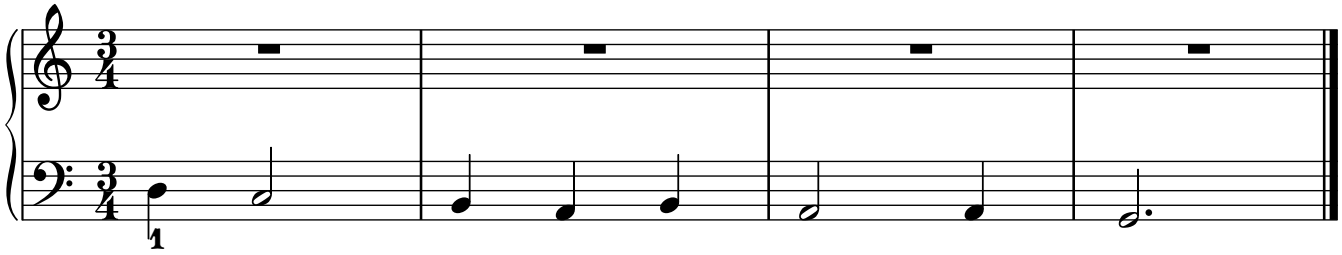
☐ **8.27**



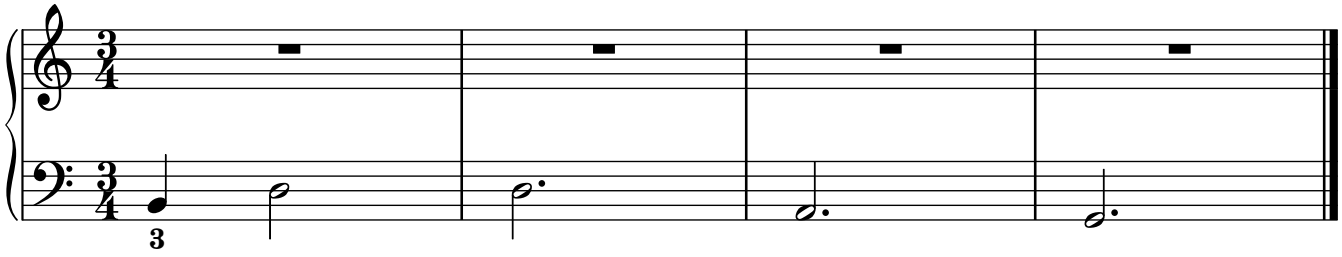
☐ **8.28**



8.29



8.30



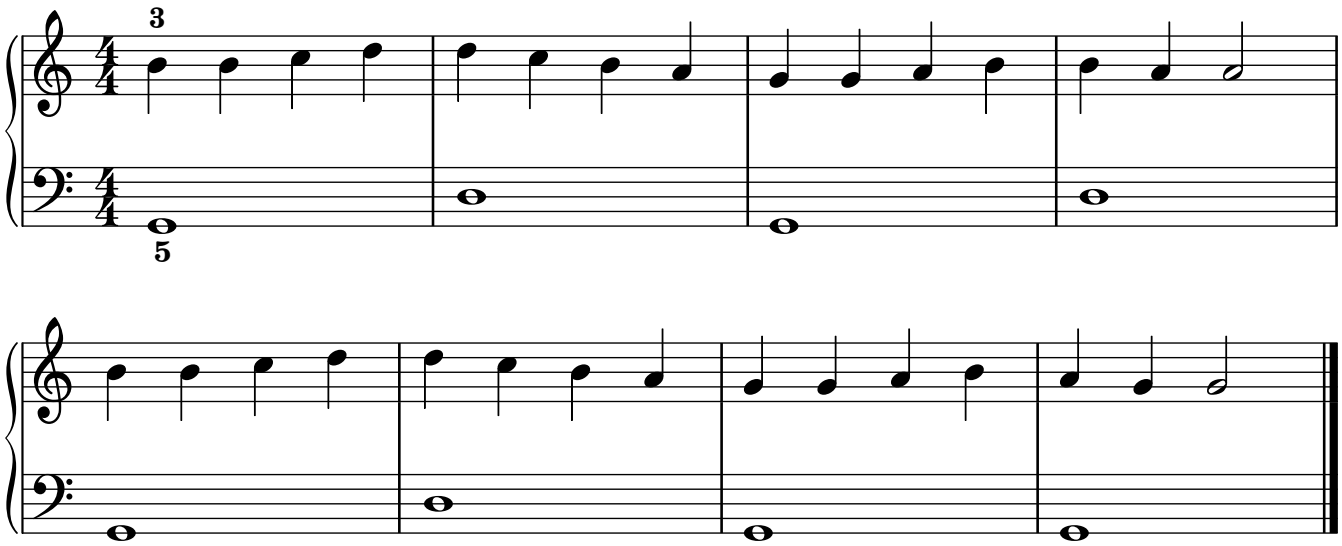
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Ode to Joy in G ♩ = 76

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified

The tune you know, starting a new position: right thumb on G, so the melody starts with finger 3 on B.



Fanfare ♩ = 80

Original

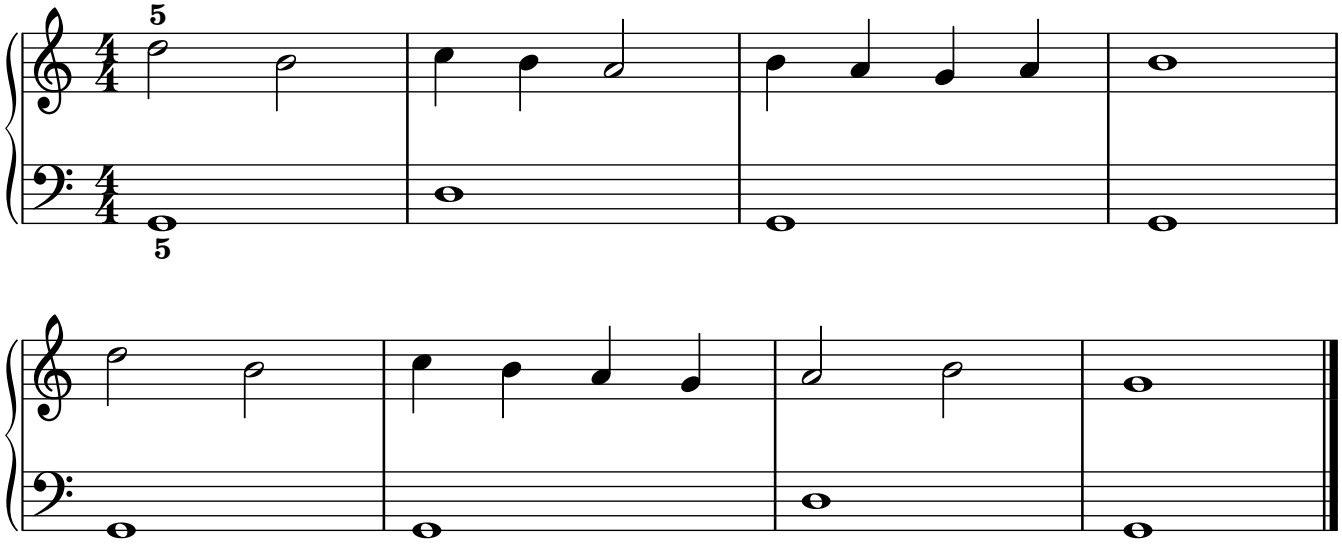
A trumpet call built from 5ths and skips. The left hand plays the same call two octaves lower.



Evening Song in G ♩ = 72

Original

A calm tune that starts with the little finger on D. The bass holds G nearly all the time.



Horn Call ♩ = 84

Original

For the left hand alone: a hunting horn echoing in the low register. The first leap is a 5th, from finger 5 to finger 1.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 9?

- Play five Part B exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if you find G position without looking at the keyboard for more than a moment.
- Pass if you play 4ths and 5ths without stopping, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 9.